

THE SISTERS HAYES

Written by

Chaz Wilke

October 4, 2013
Los Angeles

FADE IN:

EXT. SUBURBIA - SUBDIVISION STREET - DAY

An idyllic subdivision with crisp, well-kept lawns and rows of mailboxes lining the street rolls out into the distance.

Suddenly, a car rumbles through, disrupting the quaint stillness.

INT. SUBURBIA - CHLOE'S CAR - CONT'D

CHLOE, 27, has a cellphone pressed to her ear as she wrenches the rearview mirror into a position where she can see her face.

She pulls out lipstick as she chats on the phone.

CHLOE
I was ready to give up on
Craigslist, then wouldn't you know,
I get a job offer!

AMBER (O.S.)
(Over the phone)
So what are you doing again?

CHLOE
Part-time personal assistant to
some old retired actress. Uh,
Scarlette Hayes.

Chloe applies lipstick as she hurtles through the subdivision.

AMBER (O.S.)
The old theater star? One half of
Scarlette and Sophia?! Really?!

CHLOE
Oh so she was actually famous? The
listing for the job read more
delusional than factual.

AMBER (O.S.)
Those two girls practically owned
Broadway back in the 70's.

Chloe finishes applying her lipstick and purses her lips.

CHLOE
So, you're saying she'll pay well?

AMBER (O.S.)
(laughing)
We've gotta get you some real work,
my dear.

Chloe throws the lipstick on the passenger seat and starts digging in her bag for her mascara.

CHLOE
What the hell is that supposed to mean?

AMBER (O.S.)
Being near success isn't the same as finding it for yourself... Don't you have any aspirations of your own?

EXT. SUBURBIA - SUBDIVISION STREET - CONT'D

Chloe rounds the bend, turning onto another identical suburban street. A BOY, 7, plays with a red kickball on the driveway of one of the houses.

INT. SUBURBIA - CHLOE'S CAR - CONT'D

CHLOE
My bills aren't going to pay themselves, and maybe this Scarlett Hayes will have some good connections, so you know, I can rub elbows or some shit...

Chloe looks down to her hand that's wrist deep in her bag searching aimlessly for her mascara.

EXT. SUBURBIA - SUBDIVISION STREET - CONT'D

The boy bounces his ball against the garage door of his house and it flies over his head and rolls into the street. The child chases after it and directly into the path of Chloe's oncoming car.

INT. SUBURBIA - CHLOE'S CAR - CONT'D

AMBER
Just don't lose yourself into the world of indentured servitude with some old has been.

Chloe laughs as she pulls out her mascara.

CHLOE

Thanks for the bid of confidence.

Chloe looks up as her car quickly approaches the boy who just picked up his ball in the middle of the street.

EXT. SUBURBIA - SUBDIVISION STREET - CONT'D

The boy holds the ball to his chest and looks up at the car hurtling towards him like a deer in headlights.

INT. SUBURBIA - CHLOE'S CAR - CONT'D

Chloe SCREAMS! She slams on the breaks and the car comes to a SCREECHING halt.

EXT. SUBURBIA - SUBDIVISION STREET - CONT'D

The boy stands inches from the front fender of Chloe's car. For a brief second, he's shocked and motionless, then turns and runs back towards his house.

INT. SUBURBIA - CHLOE'S CAR - CONT'D

Chloe sits, head down, both hands on the wheel. One still clutching her mascara. Her cell phone lay on her lap.

AMBER (O.S.)

(faint)

What the hell was that?!

Chloe grabs the phone and slowly brings it to her ear.

CHLOE

I think I need to go. I gotta focus on driving here.

AMBER (O.S.)

It'd be a good idea not to kill someone on your first day, Chloe.

Chloe ends the call and throws her phone on the passenger seat. She rubs her temples and looks over at the boy who ran to the front door of his house where his FATHER, 38, now stands.

The boy is crying and pointing back at Chloe's car. Chloe begins to drive off slowly as she makes apologetic eyes with the boy's father mouthing the words 'I'm sorry.'

Chloe begins scanning each houses number, when suddenly her phone rings. She distractedly grabs it and brings it to her ear without looking at it.

CHLOE
I said I needed to focus! I
nearly...

SCARLETTE (O.S.)
Chloe? Hi, this is Scarlett Hayes!

CHLOE
(awkwardly)
Oh, hello Miss Hayes... Scar...
Lette...

Chloe shakes off her socially awkward greeting, hoping Scarlett doesn't make note of it.

SCARLETTE
Hey Chloe, look I'm still out at
the store, I know I said to be over
at noon, but... Are you close?

CHLOE
I'm just down the street.

SCARLETTE
Ah OK. Well, my sister is home and
I left the front door unlocked for
you. Can you just wait in the
living room until I return?

CHLOE
(awkwardly)
Will do... Boss!

Chloe cringes again at her own word choice.

SCARLETTE
Great, thanks!

Chloe ends the call and throws the phone onto the passenger seat.

EXT. HAYES RESIDENCE - MOMENTS LATER

Chloe's car rolls to a stop along the curb in front of a modest, entirely-forgettable suburban house.

Chloe pops out of the car, quickly shuts the door, and straightens her blouse as she walks up to the front door.

INT. HAYES RESIDENCE - FOYER - CONT'D

The door creaks open as Chloe pokes her head in. She faintly knocks on the door while nervously looking around.

CHLOE
(cautiously)
Hello?

She gets no response as she cautiously enters the house, closing the door slowly behind her. When the door finally closes it still makes a pronounced CLANG as it latches.

Chloe surveys the house. A modest dwelling, not too gaudy, but the walls are covered in pictures and framed clippings.

She moves towards a room across the foyer. She glances at the photos as she walks. She sees young, fresh faced girls and older men in tuxedos with beaming smiles.

There's a framed Playbill of an old Broadway play that Chloe had never heard of.

INT. HAYES RESIDENCE - LIVING ROOM - CONT'D

Chloe enters the living room and notices SOPHIA, 47, sitting in a chair near the corner of the living room. A floor to ceiling bookshelf lines the wall behind her.

On the wall next to Sophia are two framed child-sized sequined dresses.

Chloe notices that Sophia is lost in thought.

CHLOE
Hello?
(beat)
My name is Chloe, I'm Scarlett's
new personal assistant.

Sophia doesn't register.

CHLOE (CONT'D)
You... You must be Sophie?

Sophia snaps out of her gaze and turns to Chloe.

SOPHIA
(tersely)
Sophia.

Chloe recoils slightly from the icy retort.

CHLOE
Oh, I'm sorry, Sophia.
(beat)
It's a pleasure to meet you.

Chloe extends her hand. Sophia stands and holds out a limp hand for Chloe to awkwardly shake.

SOPHIA
Charmed. I'm sure.

Sophia looks Chloe up and down.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Tea?

Chloe nods and Sophia exits.

SOPHIA (O.S.) (CONT'D)
(shouting)
So you're Scarlett's new slave?

Chloe turns to look at the dresses on the wall.

CHLOE
Umm... Well, assistant.

SOPHIA (O.S.)
(shouting)
I'm messing with you, my dear!

Chloe rolls her eyes as she shifts down across a long row of framed memories on the wall. Photos and framed newspaper clippings about Broadway shows.

She continues her surveying of the room and comes across a table in front of the window that has a small collection of Hummel figurines.

Chloe takes a closer look at the small trinkets, amazed at their artistry. The small children's faces looking on with such doe-eyed wonder, Chloe catches herself smiling as she gazes at them.

She reaches out to pick one up for a closer look.

Holding one in her hand, she flips it around, looking at the small details on the piece.

Sophia enters the room carrying a tray with a tea pot and two tea cups on it. Her face snaps from a pleasant smile to dread when she sees Chloe holding the figurine.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
(insistently)
PUT THAT DOWN!

Sophia's booming command startles Chloe, which causes her to seize up and jump, dropping the figurine.

Sophia watches the small trinket fall. Her mouth widens as the figurine descends to the hardwood floor. The trinket shatters making Sophia drop the tea tray. The cacophony of SHATTERING is intensified when Sophia dashes over to the broken pieces of her beloved Hummel figurine.

Sophia pushes Chloe out of the way as Chloe attempts to mumble an apology.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Frederick! You killed Frederick!

Sophia drops to her knees surveying the pieces. She's nearly hyperventilating as she begins to scoop the shards of porcelain into her hands.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
I'm so stupid. So stupid.
(beat)
Why did I leave her in here alone
with you?

One sharp piece cuts Sophia's hand, which she doesn't even register as she hurries to scoop together every last piece.

Her blood begins to coat piece after piece as she brings them to the tabletop, resting them like a fallen comrade in front of the rest of the figurines.

Chloe looks on in regret.

CHLOE
I'm so sorry, Sophia.

Sophia is caught in a one-sided conversation with the figurines.

SOPHIA
But, she didn't know any better,
Frederick...
(beat)
I... I'm sorry... She's...
(MORE)

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
(beat)
Yes. Yes, I understand.

CHLOE
It obviously meant a lot to you. Is
there anything I can do?

This enrages Sophia. She turns to look over her shoulder. Her eyes burning with anger.

SOPHIA
Is there anything you can do?!

Sophia stands to her feet and turns square with Chloe.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Yes... There is something...

Chloe takes a step back.

CHLOE
What?

Sophia charges at Chloe. Chloe screams and is quickly silenced by Sophia's grasp around her neck.

SOPHIA
Blood for blood.

Sophia's strength easily overpowers Chloe's frail figure.

INT. HAYES RESIDENCE - FOYER - CONT'D

Sophia pushes Chloe into the foyer and slams her against the wall. Chloe's purse goes flying as Chloe's arms splay out against the wall.

SOPHIA
You killed him!
(beat)
Blood for blood...

Chloe tries to fight off Sophia. Reaching at her arms, flailing her legs trying to kick Sophia off. Finally, Chloe grabs Sophia's hair and yanks as hard as she can muster. Freeing herself from Sophia's grasp.

Chloe consoles her own neck and races to the front door, but just as she reaches it, the door flings open.

SCARLETTE, 47, is standing in the doorway. Mouth agape. She takes in the situation.

Sophia standing with her bloodied hand, nursing her head reeling from her pulled hair. And Chloe, who's collapsed to the ground, rubbing her neck.

Scarlette sees a few pieces of the tea set that had been kicked into the foyer.

SCARLETTE
What happened here?

Sophia urgently exclaims.

SOPHIA
She killed him, Scarlette!
(beat)
She killed Frederick!

Chloe returns to her feet, trying to collect herself.

CHLOE
I asked if there was anything I
could do! I'm so sorry it broke, I
was just...

Scarlette silences Chloe.

SCARLETTE
Let's all just calm down. Come
everyone, to the kitchen, we'll
work this out like adults.

INT. HAYES RESIDENCE - KITCHEN - A FEW MINUTES LATER

The shattered and bloodied pieces of the Hummel figurine lay in the center of the kitchen table.

Sophia sits, dejected, staring at the broken pieces. She's wrapped a grey dish rag around her cut hand. Chloe stares at Scarlette who is standing with her hands on her hips looking on the entire scene with maternal disgust.

Sophia pouts like a small child.

SOPHIA
She killed him, Scar...

Scarlette snaps her gaze to her sister, which makes Sophia squirm in her seat.

CHLOE
I was startled. It was an accident.

Scarlette looks at Chloe.

SCARLETTE
I understand this.

SOPHIA
She killed him, Scar! They don't
care if it was an accident.
(beat)
Blood for blood.

Scarlette motions for Sophia to quiet down then rubs her temples.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Go ask them for yourself!

Scarlette nods as Chloe scoffs at the idea.

SCARLETTE
You're right. I will.

Scarlette turns and exits the kitchen. Sophia looks at Chloe and mocks her scoffing.

A short time later the two sitting at the table hear a muffled one-sided conversation in the living room.

SCARLETTE (O.S.) (CONT'D)
(muffled)
But she meant no harm.
(beat)
It was an accident!
(beat)
Yes. Yes I know.

Scarlette returns. She looks somber, resolute.

Scarlette looks at her sister, then turns to Chloe.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)
(calmly)
Blood for Blood.

Sophia's face contorts into a massive devious grin as she springs to her feet. She motions over to a kitchen drawer and begins rummaging through it.

Chloe realizes she's the only one sitting and springs to her feet.

CHLOE
What? No. Please.
(beat)
It was a fucking accident!

Scarlette grabs Chloe's wrist and pulls her near. She holds Chloe facing towards Sophia as she digs through the drawer.

SCARLETTE

We're not arguing with you on that.
We understand you didn't mean to
kill Frederick, but they require
your blood for his.

Chloe squirms indignantly.

CHLOE

My blood for his?! But it's just
a...

She looks over to the broken pieces, still glistening with blood.

CHLOE (CONT'D)

...Trinket...

Sophia finds what she was looking for in the drawer. She quickly raises her hand triumphantly as she turns towards Chloe and her sister. She's holding a large, very sharp knife.

SCARLETTE

Don't worry honey.

Scarlette holds Chloe tight with one arm as she uses her free hand to pull back Chloe's hair maternally.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)

Sophia is great with a knife,
she'll make it quick. Won't you
sister?

Sophia nods as she starts taking steps towards Chloe.

CHLOE

You're both fucking insane! You
know that?!

Sophia lunges as Chloe slams her heel down on Scarlette's foot. Scarlette lets out a pained SCREAM as Chloe wiggles free from her grasp.

But Chloe's not fast enough, her forearm got sliced by Sophia's lunging blade.

INT. HAYES RESIDENCE - FOYER - CONT'D

Chloe screams as she races from the kitchen, through the foyer and to the front door. She tries the door, but it had been locked by Scarlett from the inside. She'll need the key to open it.

CHLOE

Locked?! Of course!

Sophia gives chase and catches up to Chloe at the door nearly instantly. Sophia flings herself knife first at Chloe but misses and slams into the door.

Chloe is stunned, struggling to get to her feet after diving out of the way. Sophia is crumpled against the door, knife stuck in the wood about half an inch.

Scarlett jingles the keys in front of her as she casually walks into the foyer.

SCARLETTE

Looking for these, Chloe? You won't be going too far without them.

Chloe's gaze darts from Sophia to Scarlett, then to the staircase. She races upstairs.

Sophia turns and sits against the door after the failed attack. She points to Chloe halfway up the staircase.

SOPHIA

She's going upstairs.

SCARLETTE

So go after her, you clod.

Sophia looks pained by the insult.

SOPHIA

Don't tell me what to do. You always tell me what to do!

SCARLETTE

Please, we both know if you took direction better we'd still be working!

SOPHIA

Oh don't you dare! Not now!

SCARLETTE

Just go after her.

Sophia rises to her feet, yanks the knife from the door and starts up the stairs. Scarlett follows.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)

(shouting)

Once the applause faded and the lights dimmed on our careers, the phone stopped ringing with calls from our managers and agents, and we were left with almost nothing! Those figurines were all we had!

Scarlette presses her foot down with intent on each step, taking her time.

INT. HAYES RESIDENCE - UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - CONT'D

Sophia makes it to the top of the stairs and starts looking in each room.

Scarlette soon follows.

SCARLETTE

(shouting)

They were more than just a reminder to us, they were the embodiment of our famous lives. We were stars God dammit!

(beat)

No one cares now, no one looks at us the same anymore. Except for them, those beautiful porcelain children, they've always looked at us the same.

Sophia returns to the hallway after checking a room.

SOPHIA

(shouting)

Does that sound strange to you?

(beat)

Do you think my sister and I are just fucking insane? Are you like the rest of them?

Scarlette grabs Sophia's arm to stand still so they could listen. She holds her finger to her mouth so Sophia doesn't speak.

Scarlette points to her bedroom.

INT. SCARLETTE'S BEDROOM - INSIDE CLOSET - CONT'D

Chloe cowers in the closet while a small slit of light beams through. She presses her eye towards the crack that's letting in the light so she can see out into the bedroom.

INT. SCARLETTE'S BEDROOM - CONT'D

Scarlette enters and looks around the room. Sophia follows soon after, crowding Scarlette as she scans the room.

SCARLETTE

God, step back! Don't crowd me.

Sophia steps back and demurs.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)

Why couldn't you have just stayed with Chloe while I was gone?

(beat)

This whole thing could've been avoided...

SOPHIA

I was making tea. I was being a good host.

SCARLETTE

That's how you justify leaving her alone with them?

SOPHIA

You're starting to sound just like mother.

SCARLETTE

Somebody has to be an adult here.

SOPHIA

It's that kind of talk that will get you a spot right next to her and father under our flower beds.

SCARLETTE

(indignant)

You need me. You needed me when we killed them and you still need me now. Don't be so damned dramatic.

INT. SCARLETTE'S BEDROOM - INSIDE CLOSET - CONT'D

Chloe recoils from the slit in the door.

CHLOE
(sotto)
They killed their parents?!

INT. SCARLETTE'S BEDROOM - CONT'D

The two sisters snap their attention to the closet and slowly start for the door.

SCARLETTE
Chloe? Is that you? Come on out
dear.

As Scarlett makes it to the door, Chloe flings it open, knocking Scarlett back. Chloe sprints out of the room, pushing Sophia out of the way in the process.

INT. HAYES RESIDENCE - FOYER - CONT'D

Chloe races down the stairs, sees her purse on the floor where she had dropped it during the initial confrontation and reaches in for her phone.

Sophia flies down the flight of stairs and snatches the phone from Chloe's hand.

Sophia looks at the phone.

SOPHIA
So close!

Sophia's eyes burn at Chloe as she throws the phone hard to her side. It hits the front door shattering into multiple pieces.

Suddenly, there's a KNOCK at the door.

Sophia seizes up and grabs Chloe, placing her hand firmly over her mouth, and dropping her knife on the floor behind her.

Another KNOCK at the door.

Scarlette heads down the stairs. With each step she composes her self more and more. Donning her old-Hollywood persona.

SCARLETTE
One moment, my dear!

She makes it to the front door, reaches in her pocket for her key, unlocks the door and casually swings it open.

MIKE, the father of the young boy that Chloe nearly ran over earlier, stands with his head tilted, clearly annoyed.

MIKE

Is everything alright? We can hear
your commotion all the way down the
street.

Scarlette stands still as she prepares her response. Mike looks in and sees Sophia covering a very distressed Chloe.

Scarlette positions her head Mike's line of sight.

SCARLETTE

We're shooting a horror movie next
week with the world renowned
director H.R. Grimly, perhaps
you've heard of him?

Mike shakes his head no.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)

He's well respected by those in the
know.

(beat)

We're just rehearsing the climactic
final confrontation right at this
very moment.

MIKE

(sotto)

Fucking actors.

He turns to leave then stops. Looking in, he takes an intent look at Chloe.

At this moment, her eyes grow wide and she tries to shout through Sophia's hand.

Mike points at Chloe.

MIKE (CONT'D)

And watch out for that one. She
nearly ran over my kid today.

Mike turns and leaves as Scarlette quickly closes the door, locks it and puts the key back in her pocket.

Scarlette turns and raises an eyebrow as she addresses Chloe.

SCARLETTE

Accident prone, aren't we, Chloe? I
didn't see anything about that on
your resume.

Scarlette starts towards Chloe and her sister. Sophia kicks the knife across the floor to her sister.

Scarlette bends to pick it up.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)
Hear that? It's your curtain call.
And you were just a bit player in a
story that never went anywhere.

Scarlette stands and starts walking towards Chloe.

SOPHIA
At least we had a moment in the
spotlight.

Scarlette nods.

SCARLETTE
We were quite a team, weren't we?

Scarlette refocuses on Chloe.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)
My sister and I achieved great
success very early because we
understood life's universal truth.

She places her hand on Chloe's shoulder and pulls the knife back, aiming at Chloe's midsection.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)
Chloe. Baby. You gotta take what
you want.

Scarlette swings the knife towards Chloe. Right before the knife makes it to her, she swings her slender frame hard to the right. The knife misses Chloe and drives deep into Sophia's midsection.

Sophia releases her grip on Chloe and begins to slowly crumple to the ground. Scarlette follows her sister down as Chloe steps aside.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)
Sophia?
(beat)
Sophie?!

Sophia holds the wound in her midsection.

SOPHIA
I hate it when you call me that.

Scarlette nods as she begins to tear up.

SCARLETTE
Just keep pressure on it. I'll
finish with her and get you to a
hospital right away.

Sophia goes still and Scarlette loses it. She'd never been without her sister in all her years.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)
No. No! Sister! Come back!

Scarlette turns to Chloe. Scarlette's face is beat red, not with anger, but fear and confusion.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)
She's... She's gone.
(beat)
I... I don't know what to do,
Chloe. She's gone.

Chloe stands defiantly in the foyer.

CHLOE
Lady, she's gone and you're
downright certifiable.

Scarlette's eyes burn with fury and stands with the knife.

SCARLETTE
You have no right to talk to me
like that you little brat! Do you
know who I am! I am Scarlette
fucking Hayes!

Chloe races to the living room and Scarlette chases after, knife wielded high above her head.

INT. HAYES RESIDENCE - LIVING ROOM - CONT'D

Chloe sprints over to the table by the window and scoops up the remaining Hummel figurines and turns just as Scarlette enters the room.

CHLOE
Stay back. You wouldn't want any
more accidents today, would you?

Chloe holds the group of trinkets in one arm like a bread basket.

Scarlette immediately stops in her tracks. Tears stream down Scarlette's face fueled by a mixture of fear, sadness, and rage.

SCARLETTE

You!

Scarlette tightly grips the knife and takes a step forward towards Chloe.

Chloe takes one figurine, raises it high above her head and throws it down viciously. SMASH!

CHLOE

Fuck!

She rapidly grabs a second and throws it to the ground. It shatters instantly. CRASH!

CHLOE (CONT'D)

You!

Scarlette recoils at the sight. She takes a step backward after each smashed trinket. Scarlette stumbles out of the room into the foyer.

INT. HAYES RESIDENCE - FOYER - CONT'D

SCARLETTE

No!

Scarlette drops her knife and clasps her ears.

SCARLETTE (CONT'D)

Stop!

Chloe SMASHES another, and another, pushing Scarlette further away from the knife she dropped.

CHLOE

You.

The last of the figures she throws directly at Scarlette instead of the ground. Scarlette anxiously catches it and cradles it.

CHLOE (CONT'D)

Deranged.

Chloe bends down and picks up the knife. She jams it into Scarlette's midsection.

CHLOE (CONT'D)

BITCH!

Chloe pulls out the knife and cuts open Scarlette's pocket and her keys fall to the ground.

Scarlette crumples to the ground next to her sister as Chloe walks to the door. She picks up her purse and unlocks the door.

She flings open the door and as she walks out, she looks back over her shoulder.

CHLOE (CONT'D)

I quit!

Scarlette falls still and the two sisters lay motionless surrounded by the shattered fragments of their Hummel figurine collection.

FADE OUT.

THE END.